

Charlemagne

The "father of modern EUROPE"

As king of the Franks and Christian emperor of the West, Charlemagne laid the foundations of modern Europe. That's why he's also known as Charles the Great.

The man who would be king

Charlemagne was born in 747 near Liège in modern-day Belgium. He was the son of the Frankish king **Pepin the Short**. Pepin died in 768 and left his kingdom to Charlemagne and his brother, Carloman. When his **BROTHER DIED** suddenly in 771, Charlemagne became **sole ruler** of the Franks.



Charlemagne personally led 53 campaigns and took part in hundreds of battles.

By the way... before me, people wrote in capital letters. I introduced lowercase letters, called Carolingian script, which is easier to read.

The Christian soldier

In 773, Pope Hadrian I asked for Charlemagne's help to **defend the Papal States** from invaders. He saw off the **POPE'S ENEMIES** and was named "protector of the Church." In his position as Papal protector, he **fought against the Muslims** in northern Spain, and conquered large parts of Germany, Switzerland, Austria, and Belgium.

Charlemagne the wise

Charlemagne organized a new system of **governors** to keep order throughout his kingdom. In addition, he used inspectors to keep an eye on the governors. He also improved **COMMERCE** by standardizing **weights and measures** (so people were guaranteed to always get the correct weight).



He devised the monetary system of pounds, shillings, and pence.



He couldn't have done it without...

Charlemagne defended **POPE LEO III** (750–816) from a rebellion in 800, so the Pope declared him **EMPEROR OF THE ROMANS**.

The Frankish scholar **EINHARD** (775–840) wrote a **BIOGRAPHY** of Charlemagne, which recorded his life and achievements in history.